

Birthday Wish System

How it works — automated birthday, child, and spouse wishes for clients.

What This System Does

Every day, the system automatically checks your client sheet for three kinds of birthdays: the client's own, their child's, and their spouse's. Depending on which one matches today's date, it sends the client a different styled email — either a direct birthday wish, or a friendly reminder to celebrate with their child or spouse. No manual checking or sending is needed once it's set up.

The Three Scenarios

If today matches...	The client receives...
Their own Birthday	A direct "Happy Birthday" wish, addressed to them personally.
Their child's Birthday	A reminder: "It's [Child]'s birthday today!" — encouraging them to celebrate.
Their spouse's Birthday	A reminder: "It's [Spouse]'s birthday today!" — encouraging them to celebrate.

These are independent — if a client's spouse and child happen to share a birthday, they'd receive both reminder emails that day.

1 How It Decides When to Send

Once a day (by default, around 8am), the system scans every row in your client sheet and compares each birthday field to today's date — matching only the **month and day**, ignoring the year. That means it works correctly every year without any updates, regardless of what year is stored in the sheet.

To avoid sending the same wish twice if the check happens to run more than once in a day, each row keeps a hidden record of the last date each type of message was sent. If it's already gone out today, it won't be sent again.

2 Editing the Messages Yourself

All wording lives in a sheet tab called **Birthday_Config** — not in code — so you can rewrite any message anytime without needing a developer.

That tab has one row per scenario:

```
Type | Subject | Body
Own | Happy Birthday, {{name}}! | Hi {{name}}, ...
Child | It's {{childName}}'s Birthday Today! | Hi {{name}}, ...
Spouse | It's {{spouseName}}'s Birthday Today! | Hi {{name}}, ...
```

You can use these placeholders anywhere in the Subject or Body:

- **{{name}}** — the client's first name (available in every message)

- **{{childName}}** — only fills in on the Child message
- **{{spouseName}}** — only fills in on the Spouse message

Lines that start with "- " automatically become a bulleted list in the email. Everything else renders as normal paragraphs, with blank lines creating paragraph breaks.

3

What the Emails Look Like

Every message — regardless of scenario — is automatically wrapped in the same branded template: a navy header with the gold "Team Excellence" wordmark, a gold divider, and your message content underneath in a clean white card. You only ever write plain text in the sheet; the styling is applied automatically every time an email goes out.

4

Testing Without Waiting for a Real Birthday

A built-in test tool lets you preview any client's emails immediately, regardless of the actual date. Point it at a specific row in the sheet, run it, and all three message types for that row get sent right away — useful for checking wording and formatting before relying on the system live.

What the Sheet Needs

- **Name** and **Email** — required for every client.
- **Birthday** — the client's own date of birth.
- **ChildName** and **ChildBirthday** — optional; leave blank if not applicable.
- **Spouse Name** and **Spouse Birthday** — optional; leave blank if not applicable.

Rows with blank child or spouse fields are simply skipped for those specific reminders — no errors, no wasted emails.

This system runs entirely on Google Sheets and Apps Script — no separate software or subscription required. It uses the same underlying approach as the New Member onboarding emails, so anyone familiar with that system will find this one follows the same logic.